



Regression Testing vs. Retesting

The "Fix" vs. The "Side Effect"

 Tags: QA, Testing, Release Management

 Reading Time: 3 min

TL;DR

Retesting verifies that a specific bug has been fixed.

Regression Testing ensures that the fix didn't break other parts of the software.

The Core Difference

These two happen at different times for different reasons.

Retesting (The Confirmation)

Focus: The Bug.

- Performed **first**.
- You are checking the specific test case that failed before.
- Question: "Is this specific bug gone?"

Regression Testing (The Safety Net)

Focus: The System.

- Performed **after** Retesting is passed.
 - You are checking features that were *working fine before*.
 - Question: "Did this new code accidentally break existing features?" (Side effects).
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The Renovation Analogy

Imagine you hire a plumber to fix a leaking shower in your bathroom.

Retesting:

You turn on the shower to see if the water still leaks.

Did the plumber fix the problem he was hired for?

Regression Testing:

You flush the toilet and check the sink to make sure the water pressure is still good.

Did fixing the shower accidentally mess up the rest of the bathroom?

The Comparison Matrix

Scenario 1: A Login Bug is Fixed

- **Retesting:** Try to log in again with the same user. Does it work now?
- **Regression:** Check the "Forgot Password" link and the "Sign Up" page. (Because the login code touches the user database, it might have affected these).

Scenario 2: When to do it?

- **Retesting:** Whenever a developer closes a bug ticket (Resolved).
- **Regression:** Before a major release or after significant code changes.

Scenario 3: Automation?

- **Retesting:** Usually Manual (because it's a unique new bug).
- **Regression:** Perfect for Automation (because it's the same repetitive checks every time).